

producing content for a blog, a regularly updated website, or any feed source.

Hub(s): A hub is the heart of this protocol. A publisher can update a single hub or multiple hubs when it publishes new content. A hub, in return, broadcasts the new content to authenticated subscribers using the push protocol methodology.

Subscribers: Subscribers are the ones who subscribe to a hub. This is generally the same as subscribing to an RSS feed. The only difference is that if the Atom file contains the definition of a hub, the RSS reader client subscribes to the specified hub instead of normal Atom feeds. This is when the latest content is served to all the users instantly.

Steps to submit

Follow the steps to announce a hub on your website, so that the users subscribing to your site's RSS feed may also be able to subscribe to the hubs.

- 1) Add a `<link />` tag in the `<head>/</head>` section of your HTML page, which has the address of the hub to which the latest content is going to be announced. For this example let us take the hub <http://pubsubhubbub.appspot.com> by Brett Slatkin.

```
<link rel="hub" href="http://pubsubhubbub.appspot.com" />
```

- 2) You need to mention the hub definition into the RSS feeds, so that users who have already subscribed may also get the notification of the hub.

```
<atom:link rel="hub" href="http://pubsubhubbub.appspot.com" />
```

- 3) Now that the announcement is done for the hub, we need a logic that pushes new content to the hub(s). Google code has a library that facilitates publishing your content to a single hub or multiple hubs. Download the PHP library from Google code (<http://trim/pubsubhubbub>). Use the following PHP code to publish it to the hub.

```
<?php
require_once(publisher.php);

//hub is defined on the following url
$hub_url = "http://pubsubhubbub.appspot.com/publish";

//create object for the class Publisher, defined in publisher.php
$publish=new Publisher($hub_url);

//URL on which new content is posted
$url="http://www.digimantra.com";

//now publish the new content using publish_update() function
$response=$publish->publish_update($url);

if($response)
    echo "Topic published, successfully";
```

else

echo "Oops !! Something is broken";

?>

So far, we've learnt some key aspects about the programmable Web, and WebHooks is just another way of mastering them. This protocol is decentralised and is often referred to by many other terms. We should not get confused with the terminology because the motive of each term is to progress towards a real-time Web. Everyone can contribute to the development of the real-time Web by writing applications that support WebHooks. There are many examples available online, explaining the implementation of WebHooks. Google Wave is the most talked of example of the programmable Web. A Google robot built in Python is one good example to help you understand how WebHooks work, practically. To get started and build your own Google Wave robot, you can go through <http://links.digimantra.com/get-started-wave>. **END** 

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